



DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
GENERAL LEONARD WOOD ARMY COMMUNITY HOSPITAL
4430 MISSOURI AVENUE
FORT LEONARD WOOD, MO 65473

MCXP-DCCS

14 August 2025

MEMORANDUM FOR All Rated Officers and NCOs

SUBJECT: Evaluations Guidance & Philosophy – DCCS

1. PURPOSE. To outline how I will generally conduct ratings.
2. OER/NCOER Philosophy. Evaluations are a key part of developing leaders and professionals. They identify strengths, address weaknesses, and guide decisions on promotions, schooling, and increased responsibility. This is not a competition—our focus is on accomplishing the mission, caring for our people, and improving GLWACH as an organization. If you consistently deliver on your mission, support your team, and contribute to making our hospital better every day, you will be recognized.
3. Motto. Work smart, Move fast, Be nice.
 - a. Work smart – Apply sound judgment, disciplined planning, and efficient processes to accomplish the mission. Use resources wisely, minimize waste, and implement improvements that have lasting impact on patient care, readiness, and hospital operations.
 - b. Move fast – Operate with a sense of urgency and adaptability. Anticipate requirements, act decisively, and meet or exceed timelines while maintaining quality, safety, and compliance.
 - c. Be nice – Treat everyone with dignity and respect while enforcing high standards. Build trust, foster teamwork, and maintain professionalism under pressure to strengthen both individuals and the organization.
4. Expectations.
 - a. The Army caps “Most Qualified” at 49% for Senior Raters, so not all strong performers will receive that mark.
 - b. I do not “stair step” ratings; I will give the highest rating to the best Officer, NCO, or civilian leader, regardless of where you fall in relation to your promotion board.
 - c. Silence from me means you are at least performing at a Highly Qualified/Proficient level.

- d. I do NOT give "Most Qualified" to Soldiers leaving the Army.

5. Rating Focus Areas.

- a. My direct observations (clinical, operational, leadership)
- b. Rater's input (if I am your SR)
- c. Senior enlisted leader perspectives
- d. Feedback from peers, subordinates, and patients (formal and informal)
- e. Contributions to hospital priorities: readiness, quality, safety, access, modernization, and organizational improvement

6. Characteristics of Performance.

- a. Highly Qualified:
 - (1) Delivers consistent, high-quality performance within mission and intent
 - (2) Communicates clearly with patients, peers, and leadership
 - (3) Works well with peers and develops subordinates
 - (4) Meets professional standards (PT, licensure, continuing education)
 - (5) Solves problems within their scope and coordinates effectively
 - (6) Synchronizes efforts across departments and units
 - (7) Enhances patient safety, access to care, and readiness
- b. Most Qualified: **Initiative (lots of it!!)**
 - (1) Fully ready to operate at the next echelon now
 - (2) Anticipates and solves higher-level problems with executable solutions
 - (3) Drives innovation (integrates new technology and improves workflow)

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- (4) Coaches and inspires others, building high-performance teams
 - (5) Exceeds professional standards (AFT, clinical certifications, leadership education)
 - (6) Executes multiple high-visibility missions simultaneously
 - (7) Understands and aligns to the operational and strategic picture, connecting GLWACH to DHA and DA readiness
 - (8) Actively develops military and civilian medical leaders
 - (9) Expands scope of practice of self and others to the fullest extent allowed
7. Final Thoughts. At GLWACH, we accomplish the mission, care for our people, and leave the organization better than we found it. Not everyone will receive “Most Qualified,” but everyone can—and must—pursue excellence. ***Ask yourself daily: What have I done to improve patient care, readiness, and this organization? Then act on it.***
8. The POC for this action is LTC Matthew D. Holtkamp at 515-371-3630 or matthew.d.holtkamp.mil@health.mil.

Matthew D. Holtkamp
LTC, MC
DCCS